

Toilet Clog Diy Solutions Guide — Action Checklist

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DIAGNOSE THE CLOG FIRST

- ❑ **Water Test:** Pour a bucket of water directly into the toilet bowl and watch what happens. If it drains slowly, you have a soft clog that responds to plunging; if it does not move or rises, you have a hard clog that requires an auger.
- ❑ **Pressure Test:** Push down once firmly with the plunger and watch the water. If it pushes out and sucks back in, the drain is open and plunging will work; if there is no movement, stop plunging because you are only moving water around.
- ❑ **Check Your Plunger:** Look at your current plunger and confirm it has an extended rubber flange hanging down from the cup. If it is flat without a flange, it is a sink plunger that cannot seal properly in a toilet and must be replaced before you do anything else.
- ❑ **Identify the Culprit:** Think about what caused the clog based on who was using the bathroom. If a child was nearby, assume a foreign object and start with the auger since toys are the most common cause of hard clogs in households.

PLUNGE WITH CORRECT FORM

- ❑ **Angle the Plunger:** Insert the plunger into the bowl at a 45-degree angle with the flange going into the drain opening first before pressing down. This positioning creates a proper seal inside the curved toilet trap that flat plungers cannot achieve.
- ❑ **Pump Aggressively:** Push down hard and pull up hard while maintaining the seal for 6 to 8 complete strokes. The pull is as important as the push because the suction dislodges material stuck on the trap walls that the push alone cannot move.
- ❑ **Repeat Three Real Attempts:** Give plunging three aggressive sessions of 6 to 8 hard strokes before moving to the auger. Stop after three real attempts with full-force plunging if the clog has not shifted at all.
- ❑ **Buy a Toilet Auger:** Purchase a toilet auger, also called a closet auger, for \$25 to \$40 at any hardware store. This is the exact same tool plumbers use on every job, and it eliminates the need for a \$200 service call on most clogs.

USE AUGER WHEN NEEDED

- ☐ **Auger After Plunger Fails:** Insert the auger cable into the drain and rotate the handle clockwise while pushing gently until you feel resistance. The mechanical cable will break through or retrieve hard blockages that plunging cannot dislodge.
 - ☐ **Know When to Stop:** Call a plumber if the auger meets steady resistance and cannot advance, if you suspect a foreign object is jammed in the trap, or if you hear grinding noises that suggest a deeper pipe issue.
 - ☐ **Check the Full Guide:** This step is described in detail in the companion guide — open toilet-clog-diy-solutions-guide_v1.md and review the relevant section.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.